

Psalms 43

Send Out Thy Light

O send out thy light and thy truth
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 • THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Judge me, O God, and plead my cause against an ungodly nation: O deliver me from the deceitful and unjust man.
- 2 For thou art the God of my strength: why dost thou cast me off? why go I mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?
- 3 O send out thy light and thy truth: let them lead me; let them bring me unto thy holy hill, and to thy tabernacles.
- 4 Then will I go unto the altar of God, unto God my exceeding joy: yea, upon the harp will I praise thee, O God my God.
- 5 Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted within me? hope in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

2 • CONTEXT

Psalm 43 continues and resolves the lament of Psalm 42, sharing its refrain and likely composed as one psalm split for temple use. It is a brief, focused plea for vindication against an unjust nation and a deceitful man, asking God to send His light and truth to guide the psalmist back to His altar and restored joy. Henry treats the pair as complaint (42) answered by petition and resolution (43), ending in worship rather than mere protest.

3 • VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

A plea: judge me, plead my cause against an ungodly nation, deliver me from the deceitful and unjust man. “Thou art the God of my strength”—so why hast Thou cast me off, why do I go mourning because of the enemy’s oppression?

Verse 3-5

A request to send out God’s light and truth to lead him back to God’s holy hill and tabernacles, so he may again go to the altar of God, “my exceeding joy,” praising Him with the harp. The refrain closes the psalm: “Why art thou cast down, O my soul?... hope in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.”

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Restoration is asked for not merely as relief from enemies but as renewed access to worship—light and truth leading back to God’s presence, not just away from trouble. The final destination of lament, in this psalm, is joy at the altar, not merely the absence of the original complaint.

Application for life today.

When seeking deliverance from a difficult situation, ask God specifically for “light and truth” to guide you, not only for the trouble to end. Notice that the psalm’s goal is worship restored (“the altar of God, my exceeding joy”)—let that reframe what you are actually praying toward. Use the shared refrain with Psalm 42 as your own settled answer to a downcast soul: hope in God, for you shall yet praise Him.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What would it look like to ask God for “light and truth” to guide you through a current conflict, rather than only asking for the conflict to end?

2. Where is God inviting you back toward worship as the real goal of a hard season, rather than merely relief?

3. How does repeating this psalm's refrain out loud change your inner conversation with your own soul?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).